

10.2 - Labor Replacement

Artificial Intelligence Policy

Prof. Jack Reilly

S2026

Think:

*How do we re-organize society and the economy in light of AI-sparked labor market disruption?
Or do we even need to - will the labor market take care of itself?*

Read:

- Frey and Osborne, 2017. “[The future of employment: How susceptible are jobs to computerisation?](#)”

Watch:

- CGP Grey, “[Humans Need Not Apply](#)”

Listen:

- Tyrangiel, 2026. “[America Isn’t Ready for What AI Will Do to Jobs](#)” Podcast: Plain English with Derek Thompson.

Browse:

- Anthropic, 2026. “[Labor market impacts of AI: A new measure and early evidence](#)”
- Tyrangiel, 2026. “[America Isn’t Ready for What AI Will Do to Jobs](#)” *The Atlantic*
- *Perhaps AI won’t be as destructive to labor markets as we think?*
 - Edwards, “[AI could create 78 million more jobs than it eliminates by 2030](#)” *Ars Technica*
 - Pethokoukis, “[Another Promising Data Point on the Productivity Impact of AI](#)” *AEIdeas*

- Acemoglu and Johnson, “[Learning from Ricardo and Thompson: Machinery and labor in the early industrial revolution – and in the age of AI](#)”

Additional Resources:

- Stiefenhofer, 2025. “[Artificial General Intelligence and the End of Human Employment: The Need to Renegotiate the Social Contract](#)”
- Thompson, 2015. “[A World Without Work](#)”. *The Atlantic*
- Two additional podcasts from the *Plain English* podcast:
 - Mollick, 2025. “[What Happens When AI Learns to Do Our Jobs](#)”. Podcast: Plain English with Derek Thompson.
 - Korinek, 2025. “[How Superintelligent AI Could Upend Work and Politics](#)”. Podcast: Plain English with Derek Thompson.
- Books:
 - Mollick, 2024. *Co-Intelligence: Living and Working with AI*. Portfolio Books.
 - Frey, 2019. *The Technology Trap: Capital, Labor, and Power in the Age of Automation*
 - Acemoglu and Johnson, 2024. *Power and Progress: Our Thousand-Year Struggle Over Technology and Prosperity* Public Affairs Books, Hachette.
- Articles
 - Frey and Osborne, 2023. “[Generative AI and the Future of Work: A Reappraisal](#)”
 - Korinek, 2024. “[Preparing for the \(Non-Existent?\) Future of Work](#)” *Oxford Handbook of AI Governance*
 - Lobel, 2024. “The Future of Work in the Era of AI”
 - Felten, “[How will Language Modelers like ChatGPT Affect Occupations and Industries?](#)”
 - [Generative AI for Economic Research](#)
 - Korinek, “Economic Policy Challenges for the Age of AI”
 - Brynjolfsson, 2025. “[Canaries in the Coal Mine? Six Facts about the Recent Employment Effects of Artificial Intelligence](#)” Working paper.
 - Gottweis et al, 2025. “[Towards an AI co-scientist](#)”. Google Research.
 - Pew Research, 2025. [Workers Experience with Chatbots and their Jobs](#)

Submit:

- Discussion question to course chat

 Tip

- “ Read”, “ Listen”, and/or “ Watch” items are required content for the day, and should be read/heard/watched before class on that day.
- “ Browse” items should be briefly looked at but do not need to be read deeply unless you want to
- “ Additional Resources” do not need to be looked at; they are there to serve, if useful, as further references for your debates, final projects, and general edification later.